MWCF: what tomorrow's call is for, and what the folder shows

1a. Máiréad's prep document, received 4 Nov at 22:07 ("Location SubCommitee 04_11_26")

It is a written briefing, not a geographic map. It answers the three things asked for at the last meeting.

- **Where clients come from: no numbers yet.** The Foundation is cleaning up its database and has asked its software partners to add regions: Limerick East, West and City; Clare North, East and West; Tipperary North and South. Next steps: define the boundaries, reallocate every client, run the report again. **Suggested deadline 30 Nov.** Ask tomorrow for any interim count by county or postcode.
- **Competition (NCCP members):** other centres serving the region, by area: Clare Cancer Support (Ennis), West Clare Cancer Centre (Kilkee), Gort Cancer Support, Circle of Friends (Tipperary), CARE (Clonmel), North Tipp Hospice (Nenagh, Roscrea, Thurles), Recovery Haven and Kerry Cancer Support Group (Tralee). Clients in the region are "primarily serviced by" MWCF; Limerick City, East and West list no alternative inside Limerick in the table I could read.
- **Capacity "dreams":** main centre: reception; a large waiting room for up to 10, doubling as a meeting room; **8 therapy rooms** (4 complementary, 4 counselling) in a quiet area; offices for marketing, admin and finance, for the GM, a "sitting room" office for client services, and one for rotating services; **one very large room for groups: Tai Chi for up to 20, talks for up to 50 lecture-style, programmes for 15 to 20**; garden, storage, private toilets, kitchen. **About four outreach locations** as miniature versions (1 therapy room, 1 counselling room, 1 office, toilets, kitchen, waiting room, possibly sublet). **Pilot suggestion: the hospital** as the first outreach location, since reflexology used to be done on wards.
- **Opening hours vision (3 to 5 years):** 5 days a week, 1 evening a week, 1 Saturday a month, 1 education evening a month. A service matrix lists therapies, services such as Citizens Information and wig fitting, support groups, education and recreational activities.

For your property brief: the San Marino design (8 therapy rooms, welcome room, general purpose room, admin, garden) matches the therapy rooms but probably not the 50-person room, the several offices or the need for outreach sites, which fits your view that it is too small. Ask Máiréad to turn the list into a schedule of rooms and floor areas so candidate properties can be tested like for like, and ask who decides the outreach pins.

1. The meeting

A sub-committee of the board (organiser Máiréad O'Donnell; you, John Lawler the Chairman and others). Review: the Data and Competition Map and the ambitions for what the service would look like. Outcomes sought: pins on the map for outreach locations, a possible pilot location, and interim and long-term location ideas (an area, not a building). Objective: a location strategy and implementation plan covering the outreach locations and the central hub, interim and long term. **Máiréad has now sent her prep document (see 1a).**

2. What John Lawler's "Building" folder holds (the San Marino project, Dooradoyle Road)

- **Pre-planning record, Limerick City and County Council, ref 1044365, 7 Nov 2025** (meeting 6 Nov 2025; attendees include Hugh Kelly of Reddy A+U, John Lawlor and Annmarie Gilmartin). Site: San Marino, Dooradoyle Road, about 1,030 sqm; demolition of a single-storey dwelling and a new support centre. **Zoning:** existing residential; health centre use is generally permitted; acceptable in principle; needs a planning statement with a robust justification. **Parking:** council says off-site parking cannot be enforced and wants some parking inside the site boundary; suggests a part two-storey design, with care for the neighbour to the north (high-level opaque windows, visual impact and daylight checks). **Access:** pedestrian and cycle only from Dooradoyle Road; vehicle access possibly from the south through Birch Grove, subject to sightlines and consent as the estate is in council charge. **Contributions:** 40 euro a sqm under the 2025 scheme unless the applicant is a voluntary, not-for-profit organisation.
- **Planning action tracker (20 Oct 2025):** design team being appointed (architect, engineers, QS and others); parking letters being sought, including from a rugby club for 20 spaces on weekdays and from a shopping centre whose owners are in Dublin; Uisce Éireann feasibility has a 16 week lead time; many reports "in progress".
- **Building survey (Feb 2025), planning-document list and an architect's presentation** (Reddy A+U, site plans and two ground and first floor options, dated 2026). Their text was partly unreadable to me.
- I did not read every page. Treat this as a summary of the main files.

3. What it means for tomorrow

- **This looks like one location option already worked up** (San Marino) with real planning detail. Tomorrow's call seems to be widening that into a strategy across outreach locations, a hub and a pilot site.
- **Key risk on San Marino:** parking inside the site, and the vehicle access through Birch Grove. These could decide whether the site works.

- **Cost note:** the contribution is waived for a voluntary not-for-profit; confirm MWCF qualifies.
- **Earlier mentions in your records:** the Chairman wanted to talk to the Mayor about council offices in Dooradoyle as a possible location, and referred to Rooney Auctioneers. These are ideas, not decisions.

3a. Finding the replacement: Gordon Kearney and other routes

- **Gordon Kearney**, ex-Chairperson of the Foundation and owner of Rooney Auctioneers (John Lawler's email of 24 Oct). You know him and his father Pat well through business. He is a natural route to candidate properties. Ask whether he can be asked, formally and with the Chairman's agreement, to shortlist sites, and whether he has any conflict to declare if his firm acts on a sale or letting.
- **Council offices in Dooradoyle:** the Chairman would like a conversation with the Mayor. A different candidate from San Marino, with "a lot of red tape" in his words.
- **McManus condition (Chairman's account):** sale of San Marino is agreed if a more suitable property is identified and there is a plan, by lease or purchase. So the shortlist and plan come first.
- **Suggested criteria for pins:** size for about 8 therapy rooms plus group and welcome space, parking on site, step-free access, close to UHL and public transport, lease or purchase cost, and time to open.

4. Questions you could ask

- What are the selection criteria for the hub and for a pilot site (access, parking, cost, proximity to UHL)?
- Is San Marino still the lead option, and what happens if parking or access fails?
- What does the Data and Competition Map show about where people live and where other support already exists?
- What is the timetable and budget for the interim location, and who owns the implementation plan?
- Who owns the shortlist of candidate properties, and will Gordon Kearney be asked to help?

Limits: I could not read the map, the full presentation or the survey. I have not verified the planning details beyond the council's own record. I have shared nothing from the folder with anyone.